

ICSE GRADE 5: SOCIAL STUDIES (SST) COMPLETE GUIDE

Chapter-wise Notes, Solved Exercises, and Revision Worksheets

TOPPER'S NOTE: EXAM-READY PREPARATION RESOURCE: This comprehensive reference contains highly structured, fact-grounded study material and textbook solutions. Formulated according to the ICSE Grade 5 curriculum, every answer is optimized for maximum marks, complete with detailed explanations, diagrams/flowcharts recommendations, and fully solved midterm revision worksheets and MCQs.

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CHAPTER 4: EVOLUTION OF TRANSPORT AND COMMUNICATION

Key Points & Important Things to Know

The Wheel: Invented about 5,000 years ago, the wheel revolutionized human life. It made transporting large and heavy goods much easier, as rolling objects experience significantly less friction than objects dragged over land.

Power Sources: Evolved sequentially over centuries. First, *muscle power* (humans and draft animals) and *wind power* (sail boats) were used. In the 18th and 19th centuries, *steam power* was harnessed (locomotives and steamships), followed by *petroleum/diesel* (motor cars and planes) in the 19th and 20th centuries, and *jet engines and electricity* in the 20th century.

Great Explorers: Travel expanded extensively due to trade. Notable explorers made historic sea journeys: Christopher Columbus (landed in the West Indies in 1492), Vasco da Gama (discovered the sea route from Europe to India via the Cape of Good Hope in 1497-1499), and Ferdinand Magellan (whose fleet completed the first circumnavigation of the globe from 1519-1522).

Evolution of Communication: Communication transitioned from early writing on Mesopotamian clay tablets and physical messengers to trained homing pigeons. Modern breakthroughs include the printing press (15th century), electric telegraph (19th century), telephone (late 19th century), and satellite/internet networks (20th and 21st centuries) that allow instant data exchange globally.

REMEMBER: The wheel made transport easier. Inventions in the 19th & 20th centuries made travel much faster. Early communication relied on physical letters and pigeons, but modern communication is near-instant due to internet, satellites, computers, and mobile networks.

New Words

Locomotive	A railway engine that pulls a train.
Technology	The use of scientific knowledge, for example in designing new machines.
Homing pigeon	A pigeon trained to find its way home from a long distance away.

Exercises & Solved Questions

A. Choose the correct answers:

- The wheel was invented about... (a) **5,000** / (b) 2,000 / (c) 1,000 years ago.
- The power of steam was used for... (a) aeroplanes / (b) **locomotives** / (c) cars.
- ... were used to send messages quickly during war. (a) **Homing pigeons** / (b) Owls / (c) Crows
- The ... system was developed to deliver letters and parcels. (a) **postal** / (b) telegraph / (c) telephone

- Statement (A): Smartphones are mini computers nowadays.
Statement (B): Smartphones are very widespread.

Answer: (b) Both A and B are true, but B is not the correct explanation of A.

B. Fill in the blanks:

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. The earliest wheeled vehicles were... | animal-drawn ones such as carts. |
| 2. As trade expanded in early times, people travelled to more... | distant places. |
| 3. Travel by steamships... | reduced the time taken for journeys. |
| 4. In ancient times, letters sometimes took... | many months or years to reach. |
| 5. Communications became... and... because of several technological developments. | easier and faster. |

C. Write True or False. Correct the false statements:

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Things that are dragged, move as fast as things that are rolled. | False. Things that roll move faster than things that are dragged. |
| 2. For many centuries, the muscle power of animals was used for land transport. | True. |
| 3. Many inventions in communication took place in the 19th and 20th centuries. | True. |
| 4. Satellites do not help to send live radio, television and telephone transmissions. | False. Communication satellites make live radio, television, and telephone transmissions possible. |
| 5. The internet is a world wide web of connections which makes instant communication possible. | True. |

D. Match the following:

Marco Polo → Travelled overland to China.	Ferdinand Magellan → Looked for a way to reach the East Indies.
Christopher Columbus → Discovered America.	1400s → First printing press.
Vasco da Gama → Found sea route Europe to India.	1800s → First typewriter / Electric telegraph in England.
1900s → Telephone, radio, TV, satellite, mobile call.	2000s → Widespread use of smartphones.

E. Answer the following questions (Topper Edition):

Q.1) How were goods for trade transported in ancient times?

In ancient times, land transport of goods relied heavily on human **muscle power** (dragging objects) and later on the muscle power of draft animals like bullocks, horses, and camels pulling wheeled carts. For water transport, traders used wooden boats propelled by the **muscle power of rowers** using oars or by **wind power** acting on canvas sails.

Q.2) What power was used by early ships and how was this different from the power used in the ships of the 19th century?

Early ships relied entirely on natural **wind power** (caught in sails) and human **muscle power** (rowers). This was significantly different from 19th-century ships, which harnessed **steam power** generated by burning coal in steam engines. Steam power enabled ships to travel faster, carry heavier cargo, and navigate independently of wind direction or currents.

Q.3) How has travel between India and Britain changed in the type of transport and the time the journey takes? Explain in two or three sentences.

In the 19th century, travel between India and Britain was done using **steamships**, taking around **six weeks**. Today, modern **jet-propelled aeroplanes** have revolutionized this route, reducing the journey time to a mere **8 to 10 hours**, making travel incredibly rapid and comfortable.

Q.4) What does communication mean?

Communication refers to the process of being in **touch and exchanging ideas with others** through speaking, writing, reading, signals, or modern digital methods.

Q.5) Arrange these 'power' words in the right time order: electricity, muscle, petrol, steam.

The correct chronological order of power development is: **1. Muscle → 2. Steam → 3. Petrol → 4. Electricity**.

Q.6) Write one sentence each about the advantages of the following inventions—printing press, telephone and radio.

- **Printing Press:** It enabled rapid mass-production of books and newspapers, making knowledge and information widely accessible and affordable.
- **Telephone:** It allowed individuals separated by vast distances to hold instant, real-time voice conversations.
- **Radio:** It made it possible to broadcast news, information, and entertainment to thousands of people simultaneously over extremely wide areas.

Picture Study (Page 45 - Ancient Manuscript Page):

1. *How long would it have taken to write such books?* ⇒ It would have taken several years of painstaking manual labor to write and illustrate a single book by hand.
2. *Would such books have been easily available to most people?* ⇒ No, these hand-written manuscripts were extremely rare, labor-intensive, and expensive, meaning they were affordable only for royalty and large institutions.
3. *Why was the printing press an important invention?* ⇒ The printing press allowed thousands of copies of a book to be produced quickly and cheaply. This spread literacy, made education accessible to ordinary citizens, and facilitated the rapid sharing of scientific knowledge.

EXAM TIP: To score full marks, draw a simple timeline showing the evolution of communication when answering questions about communication history.

CHAPTER 5: THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

Key Points & Important Things to Know

Constitution: The Constitution is the supreme book of law used to govern a country. It sets out the framework of the government and details the fundamental rights and responsibilities of both the state and its citizens.

Making the Constitution: India gained independence and formed a **Constituent Assembly** in 1946 to write its constitution. It took nearly 3 years of detailed discussions to complete. It was officially adopted on 26 November 1949 and came into force on **26 January 1950**, a landmark day celebrated across the country as Republic Day.

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar: An exceptional leader and legal scholar, Dr. Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar was appointed the **Chairman of the Drafting Committee**. He is revered as the father and chief architect of the Indian Constitution.

The Preamble: The introduction to the Constitution, summarizing its core values. It declares India to be a **Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic**. It guarantees Justice, Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity to all citizens.

Fundamental Rights & Duties: The Constitution guarantees **six Fundamental Rights** to all citizens, protecting their freedom and dignity. In return, citizens are expected to fulfill **Fundamental Duties** to respect and protect the nation's integrity.

REMEMBER: The Constitution is the supreme book of laws. The Preamble is its introduction, defining India's core values. The Directive Principles of State Policy are guidelines for making government policies. The Constitution guarantees six Fundamental Rights and demands the observance of Fundamental Duties.

New Words

Policy	A plan of action of a political party or a government.
Fundamental	The most central and important part of something.
Preamble	An introduction to a book or a written document.
Abolish	To officially end a law or a practice.
Exploitation	Treating someone unfairly, especially to make money from their work.
Minority	A smaller part of a group; less than half the people in a large group.

Exercises & Solved Questions

A. Choose the correct answers:

- The Constituent Assembly was formed in...
(a) 1945 / **(b) 1946** / (c) 1950.
- The word 'preamble' means...
(a) beginning / (b) end / **(c) introduction**.
- The Directive Principles of ... Policy help governments make policies.
(a) Government / **(b) State** / (c) Constitution
- The Constitution says that all Indian citizens are...
(a) equal / (b) unequal / (c) will become equal eventually.
- When we insist on our Fundamental Rights, the rights of other Indians should not be...
(a) disregarded / (b) allowed / (c) respected.

6. Statement (A): With Fundamental Rights come Fundamental Duties.

Statement (B): It is our Fundamental Duty to respect the Indian Constitution.

Answer: (a) Both A and B are true, and B is the correct explanation of A.

B. Write True or False. Correct the false statements:

1. The task of the Constituent Assembly was to put together the main laws for governing India.

True.

2. India began following the Constitution on 26 January 1950.

True. (Celebrated as Republic Day)

3. Areas that were ruled by kings and princes became part of India before Independence.

False. They became part of India *after* Independence.

4. The Directive Principles are laws that the government must follow.

False. They are only guidelines and recommendations, not legally binding laws.

5. There are eight Fundamental Rights in the Constitution.

False. There are **six** Fundamental Rights guaranteed by the Constitution.

6. The Right to Education makes it compulsory to give free education to children between 6 and 14 years of age.

True.

C. Match the following:

Right to Equality → All Indian citizens are equal before the law.	Right against Exploitation → No forced labor without pay.
Right to Freedom → Life and freedom is protected.	Cultural & Educational Rights → Minorities can run schools.
Freedom of Religion → Can practice any chosen religion.	Constitutional Remedies → Can go to court if rights taken away.

E. Answer the following questions (Topper Edition):

Q.1) What is a constitution?

A constitution is a supreme and essential set of **fundamental laws** according to which a country is governed. It is the basic legal framework that specifies the powers of different organs of government and regulates the relationship between the state and its citizens.

Q.2) Who was Dr. B. R. Ambedkar?

Dr. Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar was an eminent legal scholar, social reformer, and the **Chairman of the Drafting Committee** of the Constituent Assembly. Because of his leading role in compiling and organizing the draft laws, he is recognized as the chief architect and Father of the Indian Constitution.

Q.3) Why is the Preamble to our Constitution important?

The Preamble is extremely important because it is the **introduction** to the Constitution that summarizes its foundational values, ideals, and objectives. It serves as a guide, declaring India to be a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic, and aiming to secure Justice, Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity for all its people.

Q.4) What are the Directive Principles of State Policy?

The Directive Principles of State Policy are constitutional **guidelines or recommendations** meant to assist governments in making laws and policies. Though they are not legally binding laws, they remind governments of their responsibility to work towards the social and economic welfare of the people, putting the ideals of the Preamble into practice.

Q.5) What is the difference between Fundamental Rights and Fundamental Duties?

Fundamental Rights are the basic, essential freedoms guaranteed to every Indian citizen by the Constitution (e.g., equality, freedom of speech). They are **justiciable laws**, meaning if they are violated, a citizen can approach a court of law for justice.

In contrast, **Fundamental Duties** are the core **moral responsibilities** that citizens are expected to perform towards their country (e.g., respecting the National Flag, protecting public property, protecting the environment). Unlike rights, duties are non-justiciable in court.

Q.6) Why do you think that Fundamental Duties are a part of the Constitution?

Fundamental Duties are part of the Constitution because in a healthy democracy, **rights and duties are mutually dependent**. To continuously enjoy our rights, we must also fulfill our duties. They remind citizens of their responsibilities to protect national unity, safeguard public property, care for the environment, and respect the rights and freedoms of others.

Picture Study (Page 56 - Fundamental Duties in action):

1. *What are the Fundamental Duties shown in the two pictures?*

⇒ **Picture 1 (Towards People of India):** To promote harmony and the spirit of common brotherhood amongst all the people of India, respecting diversity.

⇒ **Picture 2 (Towards Natural Environment):** To protect and improve the natural environment, including forests, lakes, rivers, and wildlife, and to show compassion for all living creatures.

2. *How can we ensure that we fulfill these Fundamental Duties?*

⇒ We can fulfill them by treating every fellow citizen with respect and kindness, refusing to participate in violence, reducing pollution, conserving water resources, planting trees, and respecting public spaces.

IMPORTANT KNOWLEDGE: Topper's Note - The Six Fundamental Rights of India:

1. **Right to Equality** (Equal treatment before law)
2. **Right to Freedom** (Freedom of speech, assembly, and movement)
3. **Right against Exploitation** (Abolition of forced labor and child labor)
4. **Right to Freedom of Religion** (Freedom to follow any religion)
5. **Cultural and Educational Rights** (Allows minorities to protect their culture and run schools)
6. **Right to Constitutional Remedies** (Allows citizens to go to court if rights are taken away)

CHAPTER 6: INDIA'S DEMOCRATIC GOVERNMENT

Key Points & Important Things to Know

Three Branches of Government: To prevent abuse of power, the Constitution divides state authority into three branches:

- 1. The Legislature (Parliament/Sansad):** Responsible for making laws and approving the national budget. It is bicameral, comprising the *Lok Sabha* (Lower House, directly elected by people) and the *Rajya Sabha* (Upper House, representing states).
- 2. The Executive:** Responsible for formulating policies and implementing laws. Led by the *President* (head of state) and the *Prime Minister and Cabinet of Ministers* (real power at the Centre). At the state level, it is led by the *Governor* and the *Chief Minister*.
- 3. The Judiciary:** Responsible for interpreting laws, explaining the Constitution, and settling disputes fairly. It is a unified, single system that acts as a guardian of citizens' fundamental rights.

Checks and Balances: A vital democratic principle where each of the three branches acts as a check on the others, ensuring a balanced distribution of power where no single organ becomes dominant.

Federal Structure: Power is shared between the Union (Central) Government in New Delhi and the respective State Governments.

Division of Power (Three Lists):

- **Union List:** Subject areas under exclusive Central jurisdiction (e.g., Railways, Defense, Foreign Affairs).
- **State List:** Areas under exclusive State jurisdiction (e.g., Police, law and order, health).
- **Concurrent List:** Subjects where both Centre and States can legislate (e.g., Education, Electricity). If there is a conflict, Central law prevails.

REMEMBER: The powers of the Indian state are divided between the legislature, the executive, and the judiciary. A system of checks and balances maintains democratic accountability. Power is shared between central and state governments. The judiciary is a unified, pyramid-shaped system.

New Words

State	A country controlled by one government.
Federal	A system of government where states have control over their own affairs, but are controlled by a central government for national decisions.
Dispute	A disagreement between two people, groups or countries.
Administrator	A person who manages a company or an institution (used for governing Union Territories directly).

Exercises & Solved Questions

A. Choose the correct answers:

- In a democracy, the state is governed...
(a) according to its constitution / (b) as the government likes.
- The Indian state has...
(a) 5 / (b) 3 / (c) 4 branches.

3. Indian states make laws for...

(a) the whole country / **(b) their own state** / (c) their state and neighbours.

4. The ... branch of the state has ministers who carry out the policies.

(a) executive / (b) legislative / (c) judicial

5. Statement (A): The legislature and the executive are different at the centre and in the states.

Statement (B): The judiciary of the entire country is one system.

Answer: (a) Both A and B are true, and B is the correct explanation of A.

B. Fill in the blanks:

1. ... means a country that is controlled by one government.

State

2. The ... is head of the country and the ... is head of a state.

President and Governor

3. The Supreme Court is the ... court in India.

highest

4. The judiciary explains the meaning of the ... when it is not clear.

Constitution

5. The ... also makes sure that people get justice.

judiciary

C. Write True or False. Correct the false statements:

1. Legislatures have no control over how the government manages its money.

False. Legislatures discuss, review, and approve the plans for how the executive gets and spends public money (the budget).

2. In a federal structure, power is divided between the union and state governments.

True.

3. The real power in the central government is with the Prime Minister and in the state with the Chief Minister.

True.

4. The Concurrent List mentions the powers that are shared by the union and state governments.

True.

5. The judiciary does not protect the rights and freedoms of Indian citizens.

False. A key role of the judiciary is to protect the fundamental rights and freedoms of Indian citizens.

6. Disputes are settled by the legislatures according to the law.

False. Disputes are settled by the **judiciary** according to the law.

D. Match the following:

Rashtrapati → President	Vidhan Sabha → Legislative Assembly
Rajyapal → Governor	MP / MLA → Member of Parliament / Member of Legislative Assembly

E. Answer the following questions (Topper Edition):

Q.1) Explain in a short paragraph why a system of checks and balances is important in a democracy.

A system of **checks and balances** is highly important because it ensures that no single branch of the state (Legislature, Executive, or Judiciary) accumulates absolute power. Each branch exercises a constitutional limit on the power of the other two. For example, the Legislature creates laws, but the Executive implements them, and the Judiciary can strike down a law if it is unconstitutional. This mutual check ensures fair governance and

protects citizens' rights.

Q.2) Give two differences and two similarities between the legislatures at the centre and in the states.

• Similarities:

1. Both central and state legislatures hold their respective executive branches accountable for their administrative decisions.
2. Both debate, modify, and vote on the financial budgets showing how public money is raised and spent.

• Differences:

1. The central legislature (Parliament) makes laws for the entire country, whereas state legislatures (Vidhan Sabha) only make laws for their own state.
2. The central legislature is strictly **bicameral** (Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha), whereas most state legislatures are **unicameral** (consisting only of the Vidhan Sabha).

Q.3) Name the three lists under which power is shared between the centre and the states. Give one example of the subject under each list.

Power is shared via three legislative lists:

1. **Union List:** Covers matters of national interest under exclusive Central jurisdiction. *Example:* Railways, Defense, Minting Currency.
2. **State List:** Covers state-specific matters under state government jurisdiction. *Example:* Police, law and order, health.
3. **Concurrent List:** Shared subjects where both Central and State governments can enact laws. *Example:* Education, electricity, forests.

Q.4) Explain the pyramid-shaped structure of the judiciary with the help of a diagram.

The Indian judiciary functions as a single, unified system organized in a strict pyramid structure:

- **At the Top:** The **Supreme Court of India** (located in New Delhi), headed by the Chief Justice of India. It is the highest authority and final court of appeal.
- **In the Middle:** The **High Courts**. There are 25 High Courts across India, each acting as the highest judicial authority at the state level, headed by a Chief Justice.
- **At the Bottom:** The **District and Subordinate Courts**, operating in several hundred districts across the country to handle primary cases.

Q.5) How are union territories different from the states of India?

The primary difference lies in their administration and governance: **States** possess their own elected legislative assemblies and executive governments (headed by a Chief Minister and Governor) with broad powers to rule on state subjects. In contrast, **Union Territories are governed directly by the Central Government** through an appointed **administrator**. However, Delhi and Puducherry are unique Union Territories that exceptionally have their own elected assemblies and Chief Ministers.

JUDICIARY STRUCTURE: Visual Representation - The Indian Judiciary Pyramid:

/ SUPREME COURT \	(1 Court, New Delhi - Chief Justice of India)
/ HIGH COURTS \	(25 Courts at State Level - Chief Justices)
/ DISTRICT COURTS \	(District and Subordinate Courts across India)

Picture Study (Page 63 - All MPs and MLAs meeting in Parliament):

Why is it important for all MPs or MLAs to meet together in Parliament or the Legislative Assemblies?

⇒ MPs and MLAs represent the millions of citizens of India. Because it is physically impossible for all citizens to sit in a room and make decisions, these representatives meet on their behalf to debate pressing public issues, draft and pass laws, and monitor government spending. This meeting ensures that the government is governed strictly by the consent and will of the people, keeping democracy functional.

CHAPTER 7: ELECTIONS IN INDIA

Key Points & Important Things to Know

Constituencies: To facilitate elections, the nation (for national elections) and states (for state elections) are partitioned into geographical areas called constituencies. Each constituency elects exactly **one representative** to the respective legislature. National constituencies are much **bigger** than state constituencies.

The Election Commission: An **independent, constitutional organization** responsible for conducting, regulating, and supervising elections in India. It prepares the official **electoral roll** and issues Voter ID cards, ensuring that voting is transparent, free, and unbiased.

Universal Adult Franchise: Every Indian citizen who is **18 years of age or older** has the fundamental right to vote, irrespective of gender, caste, religion, or economic background.

EVM (Electronic Voting Machine): A modern machine used in polling booths to record and count votes electronically. Voters press a button next to the candidate's name and symbol, making the process secure, easy, and environment-friendly by saving paper.

Secret Ballot: A cornerstone of democratic elections where voters mark their choices in private behind a screen, preventing any outside pressure or threat.

Government and Opposition: The political party that wins the most seats (majority of constituencies) forms the executive government. Other parties form the **opposition**, whose responsibility is to keep the government accountable by questioning its policies.

REMEMBER: The country is divided into constituencies, each electing one representative. The independent Election Commission supervises elections. Voting is done via secret ballot using EVMs. Every citizen of 18 or above has the right to vote. The party with the most wins forms the government, while others form the opposition.

New Words

Candidate	A person who stands for election.
Constituency	A part of a city, state or country that has its own elected representative.
Representative	A person who has been chosen to act on behalf of a group.
Electoral roll	The official list of people who have the right to vote in a particular area.
Polling booth	A small place separated from the surrounding area, where people vote.
Ballot	A system of voting, usually in secret.
Opposition	Political parties that are in a parliament but are not part of the government.

Exercises & Solved Questions

A. Choose the correct answers:

1. Constituencies for national elections are ... than constituencies for state elections. **(a) bigger / (b) smaller / (c) the same size**

2. An election symbol is given... (a) to each constituency / **(b) to each political party** / (c) to the Election Commission.
3. The ... is responsible for making sure that people can vote freely. **(a) Election Commission** / (b) President / (c) Prime Minister
4. In an EVM, people ... to choose their candidate. (a) write on a paper / **(b) press a button** / (c) mark X on a card.
5. Statement (A): Every eligible voter can vote only once in elections.
Statement (B): Voters' fingers are marked with ink that takes many days to fade.
Answer: (a) Both A and B are true, and B is the correct explanation of A.

B. Fill in the blanks:

1. Every ... elects its own representative for the government. **constituency**
2. The ... is an independent organization. **Election Commission**
3. In India, the voting age is ... years and above. **18**
4. The political party that has the most winning candidates forms the... **government.**
5. The ... is made up of those elected members whose party did not win the election. **opposition**

C. Match the following:

Electoral roll → Contains names of registered voters.	Voter ID card → Issued by the Election Commission.
Polling booth → The place where people go to vote.	Candidate → A person who stands for election.
Constituency → Part of country/state electing an MP/MLA.	

E. Answer the following questions (Topper Edition):

Q.1) What is a political party?

A political party is an organized **group of people who share the same ideology and vision** about how a country should be governed. They choose candidates, contest democratic elections, and attempt to form the government to implement their policies.

Q.2) Why do candidates make speeches to the people of their constituency?

Candidates hold public speeches, rallies, and distribute manifestos to **campaign and persuade voters** within their constituency. These speeches explain their plans, promises, and solutions for local issues, helping voters make an informed choice on election day.

Q.3) Why do you think that voting is done by a secret ballot?

Voting is conducted via **secret ballot** to protect the fundamental freedom of voters. By ensuring the EVM is enclosed in a private compartment, it guarantees that citizens can vote **safely, privately, and honestly**, without any fear, pressure, or threat of retribution from any candidate or political group.

Q.4) After an election, which political party forms the government and what is the role of the other parties? Write a few sentences about this.

After an election, the political party (or coalition) that wins the **majority of seats** (constituencies) is invited to form the government. The remaining elected parties constitute the **opposition**. Their role is to critically analyze government policies, voice alternative opinions, and act as a safeguard against any misuse of power.

Q.5) Who has power in a democracy? Why?

In a democracy, the **ultimate power lies with the people** of the country. This is because citizens elect the representatives who run the state. If the government fails to address people's needs or misgoverns, the public has the power to vote them out of office in the subsequent election.

Q.6) Why is it the duty of citizens to vote? Explain in a few sentences.

Voting is an essential civic duty because **every single vote counts and shapes the government**. By voting, citizens actively maintain the democratic structure, participate in choosing capable and honest leaders, and ensure their concerns are protected and addressed.

Picture Study (Page 70 - EVM Voting & Paper Ballot comparison):

Why have paper ballots been replaced by EVMs in India?

⇒ Paper ballots were replaced by EVMs to protect the environment by saving thousands of tons of paper (trees), simplify the voting process for illiterate and elderly voters, prevent illegal practices like ballot box stuffing, and drastically reduce the time needed to count votes and announce election results.

CHAPTER 8: SOLAR AND LUNAR ECLIPSES

Key Points & Important Things to Know

Eclipse Definition: An eclipse is a natural, predictable scientific event that occurs when a celestial body (Sun or Moon) is temporarily blocked, either partially or fully, by the shadow of another celestial body.

Astronomical Causes: Eclipses occur due to three main factors: (1) The orbit of the Moon around the Earth, (2) The orbit of the Earth around the Sun, and (3) The physical law of shadow formation when light falls on an **opaque** object (Earth or Moon).

Solar Eclipse: Occurs when the ****Moon passes directly between the Sun and the Earth****, casting its shadow on the Earth. The sky grows dark, birds stop singing, and the Sun is blocked from view. A solar eclipse can occur only on a ****New Moon (Amavasya) day**** and must never be viewed with the naked eye.

Lunar Eclipse: Occurs when the ****Earth passes directly between the Sun and the Moon****, blocking sunlight from reaching the Moon. The Earth's shadow falls on the Moon, making it look dark and occasionally reddish (due to light bending through the Earth's atmosphere). It occurs only on a ****Full Moon (Poornima) day**** and is perfectly safe to watch with the naked eye.

REMEMBER: The orbits of the Moon and the Earth and their shadows cause eclipses. Solar eclipses occur when the Moon is between the Sun and Earth on a new moon day. It is highly dangerous to look directly at a solar eclipse. Lunar eclipses occur when the Earth is between the Sun and Moon on a full moon day.

New Words

Phenomena	A significant event in nature; phenomena is the plural of phenomenon.
Astronomer	A scientist who studies the sun, moon, stars, planets, etc.
Opaque	Not clear enough to allow light through; the opposite of transparent.

Exercises & Solved Questions

A. Choose the correct answers:

- In ancient times, most people had ... explanations for why an eclipse happened. (a) logical / (b) scientific / **(c) unscientific.**
- A solar eclipse is when the ... is completely or partially hidden. **(a) sun** / (b) moon / (c) earth
- A lunar eclipse is when the ... is completely or partially hidden. (a) earth / (b) sun / **(c) moon**
- A lunar eclipse lasts for a few... (a) minutes / **(b) hours** / (c) days.
- Statement (A): It is unsafe to look at a solar eclipse.
Statement (B): Solar eclipse is the eclipse of the sun. **Answer: (b) Both A and B are true, but B is not the correct explanation of A.**

B. Write True or False. Correct the false statements in your notebook:

- 'Sol' means the moon and 'luna' means the sun. **False.** 'Sol' means the sun and 'luna' means the moon.
- During a total solar or lunar eclipse, the three heavenly bodies—the sun, the moon and the earth—are in a straight line. **True.**

3. It is not safe to look at a solar eclipse even with dark glasses.
4. Solar and lunar eclipses both last for the same amount of time.
5. We now know how and why eclipses happen, so we should not be frightened of them.

True. (Only certified solar viewing glasses protect eyes).

False. Solar eclipses last only a few minutes, whereas lunar eclipses last for several hours.

True.

C. Fill in the blanks:

1. An ... happens when shadows fall on the earth or the moon. **eclipse**
2. When light falls on an ... object, the shadow falls on the opposite side. **opaque**
3. In a ... eclipse, the moon is between the sun and the earth. **solar**
4. A ... eclipse is unsafe to see without protection. **solar**
5. We must only believe ... explanations about eclipses. **scientific**

D. Match the following:

Sol → (d) The sun	Eclipse → (a) Being hidden
Luna → (b) The moon	Astronomers → (c) Scientists studying sun, moon, stars, etc.

E. Answer the following questions (Topper Edition):

Q.1) How do we know the real reason why eclipses happen?

We understand the true nature of eclipses due to the empirical observations and research of **scientists and astronomers**. They observed celestial orbits and analyzed shadows, demonstrating that eclipses are natural astronomical events caused by shadows rather than magical or unscientific legends.

Q.2) Give the three reasons why eclipses happen.

Eclipses are caused by:

1. The orbit of the Moon around the Earth.
2. The orbit of the Earth around the Sun.
3. The law of shadow formation when sunlight is blocked by an **opaque** body (the Earth or Moon).

Q.3) Why should we not look at the sun directly during a solar eclipse?

We must never look directly at a solar eclipse because the Sun's intense rays (especially ultraviolet and infrared radiation) can focus on the retina, causing severe, painless, and permanent damage or complete blindness. Regular sunglasses do not offer protection; only certified solar viewing glasses must be used.

Q.4) In two sentences describe what happens during a partial lunar eclipse.

During a partial lunar eclipse, the Sun, Earth, and Moon are not in a perfectly straight line, and only a portion of the Moon passes into the Earth's dark shadow (umbra). The shadow appears as a dark, circular bite on the Moon's face, while the rest remains brightly lit.

Q.5) Sometimes we are not able to see solar eclipses that occur. Why is this?

We may miss a solar eclipse because of poor atmospheric conditions like clouds, fog, or heavy smog. Furthermore, unlike lunar eclipses, a solar eclipse can only be observed from a very narrow path on the Earth's surface where the Moon's shadow actually sweeps across.

VISUALIZING ECLIPSES: Solar Eclipse Alignment: SUN → MOON (Umbra shadow on Earth) → EARTH (On a New Moon Day)

Lunar Eclipse Alignment: SUN → EARTH (Umbra shadow on Moon) → MOON (On a Full Moon Day)

ICSE SST MIDTERM PAPER PATTERN

Tree House High School, Shewalewadi

SECTION I (40 Marks)	Q.1 Choose the correct option from the following (1x16=16 marks) Q.2 Assertion and Reasoning Questions (1x4=4 marks) Q.3 State True or False. Correct the false statements (1x5=5 marks) Q.4 Write meanings of the following terms (1x5=5 marks) Q.5 Match the following items (1x5=5 marks) Q.6 Arrange the items in the correct order (1x5=5 marks)	40 Marks
SECTION II (40 Marks)	Q.7 Answer in one or two sentences each (1x5=5 marks) Q.8 Answer in three to four sentences (Any 5) (3x5=15 marks) Q.9 Write short notes on specified topics (3x4=12 marks) Q.10 Differentiate between specified terms (2x2=4 marks) Q.11 Observe the picture and answer the questions (1x4=4 marks)	40 Marks
TOTAL WEIGHTAGE	Section I + Section II Combined	80 Marks

REVISION WORKSHEET I - FULL SOLUTIONS

Tree House High School | Social Studies | Revision Worksheet I

Q.1) Choose the correct option from the following:

1) Which statement correctly compares a solar and lunar eclipse?

⇒ **b) In a solar eclipse, the Moon's shadow falls on Earth; in a lunar eclipse, Earth's shadow falls on the moon.**

2) What made the invention of the wheel important?

⇒ **b) It helped people travel and transport goods more easily**

3) Which of the following is not a feature of a democratic government?

⇒ **d) Rule by a hereditary king**

4) A candidate promises to work for the people after being elected. What should citizens do before voting?

⇒ **b) Learn about the candidate and make an informed decision**

5) Which list allows both the Central and State Governments to make laws?

⇒ **c) Concurrent List**

6) Education is placed in the Concurrent List. What does this mean?

⇒ **c) Both the Centre and States can make laws about education.**

7) During a lunar eclipse, the Moon may appear reddish because:

⇒ **b) Sunlight passing through Earth's atmosphere is bent towards the Moon.**

8) Which statement best explains the relationship between the Constitution and citizens?

⇒ a) The Constitution protects certain rights and lays down duties and principles governing citizens and the state.

Q.2) Answer in one sentence each:

1) *What is a Constitution?*

⇒ A Constitution is the supreme book containing the fundamental set of laws and principles used for governing a country.

2) *What is the role of the Executive?*

⇒ The Executive branch of government is responsible for creating and executing policies and making sure that parliamentary laws are carried out.

3) *Who conducts elections in India?*

⇒ Elections in India are conducted and supervised by the **Election Commission of India**, which is an independent, constitutional organization.

4) *How would life be different if there were no modern means of transport and communication?*

⇒ Without modern transport and communication, traveling to distant places would take months or years on foot or sailboats, and we would have no way to communicate instantly with distant family or friends, making our world feel massive and completely disconnected.

5) *What happens after people cast their votes?*

⇒ After people cast their votes, the Election Commission oversees the secure electronic counting of votes, and the candidate with the highest number of votes in each constituency is declared elected as its representative.

Q.3) Answer the following in detail:

1) Explain why it is dangerous to look directly at the Sun during a solar eclipse. How can it be observed safely?

Looking directly at the Sun during a solar eclipse is highly dangerous because the extreme intensity of the Sun's rays (including harmful ultraviolet and infrared radiation) can focus directly on the retina, burning the light-sensitive tissues and causing permanent eye damage, a condition known as solar retinopathy, or even complete blindness. It can be safely observed **only by using certified solar viewing glasses** or eclipse viewers specifically manufactured to safe standards. Viewing through ordinary sunglasses, cameras, telescopes, or binoculars is unsafe and will cause serious, immediate eye injuries.

2) What is the Preamble? Explain the main ideals mentioned in the Preamble of the Indian Constitution.

The Preamble is the introductory statement to the Constitution of India that lists the core values, philosophy, and goals of the nation. The major ideals mentioned are:

- **Sovereign:** India is entirely independent and free from any external rule or control.
- **Socialist:** The nation's wealth should be shared equally among all citizens to bridge the gap between rich and poor.
- **Secular:** The state has no official religion; all religions are treated with equal respect and freedom.
- **Democratic:** The government is chosen by the people through elections, holding authority through public consent.
- **Republic:** The head of the state (President) is an elected official, not a hereditary king or ruler.

3) Explain how means of communication have changed over time, from letters and messengers to mobile phones and the internet.

In ancient times, communication was extremely slow, relying on messengers on foot or horseback carrying written letters on clay or paper, which took months or years to arrive. Occasionally, trained homing pigeons were used during wars. The 15th-century printing press made newspapers and books possible, and the 19th-century electric telegraph and telephone allowed people to communicate instantly over wires. In the late 20th and 21st centuries, the development of communication satellites, computers, smartphones, and the internet completely revolutionized communication, allowing individuals to send text, images, and hold high-definition video calls in a split-second globally.

4) Explain the Union List, State List and Concurrent List with suitable examples.

India shares legislative responsibilities through three lists:

- **Union List:** Subject areas of national importance. Only the Central Government can make laws. *Examples:* Railways, Defense, Minting Coins.
- **State List:** Subjects of state-level or local importance. State Governments have exclusive lawmaking powers. *Examples:* State Police, Law and Order, Public Health.
- **Concurrent List:** Subjects of mutual interest. Both Central and State Governments can legislate. *Examples:* Education, electricity, and forestry. If there is a conflict, the law enacted by the Central Government is followed.

Q.4) Challenging Questions:

1) *Why can we safely watch a lunar eclipse with our naked eyes but should not look directly at a solar eclipse?*

⇒ A lunar eclipse is safe because we are viewing the Moon, which does not produce its own light; it only reflects the weak, harmless sunlight. However, during a solar eclipse, we are looking directly at the Sun, which emits highly intense, concentrated light and dangerous radiation that can instantly burn the retina of our eyes.

2) *A person votes for a candidate only because the candidate is their friend. Is this a good way to vote? Give a reason.*

⇒ No, this is not a good voting practice. Voting is a major civic responsibility. Citizens should vote for candidates based on their competence, integrity, leadership quality, and manifesto promises to work for the welfare of the entire constituency, rather than personal friendships, to ensure good governance.

3) *How have mobile phones and the internet made communication easier than sending letters?*

⇒ Unlike physical letters, which take days, weeks, or months to be physically transported, mobile phones and the internet transmit messages instantly via email or chat. They also allow interactive real-time audio and video conversations, are much cheaper, and support the immediate sharing of documents, photos, and media.

4) *Why is the Constitution called the supreme law of our country?*

⇒ The Constitution is called the supreme law because it is the ultimate authority. Every other law, act, or policy made by the central or state governments must agree with the rules and principles written in the Constitution. If any law contradicts the Constitution, the judiciary can declare it unconstitutional and void.

5) *What are Fundamental Rights? Name any four Fundamental Rights guaranteed to Indian citizens.*

⇒ Fundamental Rights are the core, basic human rights guaranteed by the Constitution to all Indian citizens to ensure they can live with freedom, equality, and dignity in a democracy. Four of these rights are: (1) Right to Equality, (2) Right to Freedom, (3) Right against Exploitation, and (4) Right to Freedom of Religion.

REVISION WORKSHEET II - FULL SOLUTIONS

Tree House High School | Social Studies | Revision Worksheet II

Q.1) Fill in the blanks:

- 1) The Constitution of India came into effect on...
⇒ **26 January 1950** (celebrated as Republic Day).
- 2) Respecting the National Flag and National Anthem is a...
⇒ **Fundamental Duty**.
- 3) The Preamble begins with the words...
⇒ **'We, the people of India'**.
- 4) The area represented by an elected member is called a...
⇒ **constituency**.
- 5) Voting is an important way for citizens to participate in a...
⇒ **democracy**.
- 6) An ... is one of the fastest means of transport.
⇒ **aeroplane**.
- 7) Special ... glasses should be used to observe a solar eclipse safely.
⇒ **solar viewing** glasses.
- 8) The ... interprets laws and provides justice.
⇒ **Judiciary**.

Q.2) State True or False. Correct the statements that are false:

- 1) Dr. B. R. Ambedkar was the Chairman of the Drafting Committee.
⇒ **True**.
- 2) In a democracy, people choose their representatives through elections.
⇒ **True**.
- 3) Elections are held only to choose the Prime Minister.
⇒ **False**. Elections are held to choose Members of Parliament (MPs) or Members of Legislative Assembly (MLAs). These elected members then elect their leaders, who are appointed as the Prime Minister (at the Centre) or Chief Minister (in the States).
- 4) Solar and lunar eclipses occur every month.
⇒ **False**. Eclipses do not occur every month because the Moon's orbit around the Earth and the Earth's orbit around the Sun are tilted at an angle and do not align in a perfect straight line every month.
- 5) Communication means travelling from one place to another.
⇒ **False**. Communication means to be in touch and exchange ideas with others through speaking, writing, reading, or other methods. Travelling from one place to another is called *transport*.

Q.3) Assertion and Reasoning Questions:

1) **Assertion (A):** Ships are a means of air transport.

Reason (R): Ships travel on water.

Answer: d) A is false, but R is true.

Correction: Ships are water-borne vessels and represent water transport, not air transport.

2) **Assertion (A):** Fundamental Rights and Fundamental Duties are exactly the same.

Reason (R): Rights give citizens certain freedoms, while duties remind them of their responsibilities.

Answer: d) A is false, but R is true.

Correction: Fundamental Rights and Duties are complementary but not the same; Rights represent guaranteed freedoms, while Duties represent social/moral responsibilities.

3) **Assertion (A):** Every child can vote in an election.

Reason (R): Citizens must generally be 18 years or above to vote, subject to legal requirements.

Answer: d) A is false, but R is true.

Correction: Children under 18 years cannot vote. In India, voting eligibility begins strictly at 18 years or above.

4) **Assertion (A):** Communication has become faster over time.

Reason (R): Mobile phones and the internet allow people to exchange information quickly.

Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

Q.4) Match the following:

1) EVM	c) Records votes electronically
2) Moon's shadow	d) Moon between Sun and Earth (shadow falls on Earth during a Solar Eclipse)
3) Central Government	e) Government for the whole country
4) Right to Equality	b) Equality before law
5) Letter	a) Communication through written messages

GRADE 5 MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS (MCQs) SHEET

Comprehensive ICSE Grade 5 Exam-Ready MCQs with Answers

1. The earliest means of transport used by man was:
⇒ **C) walking**
2. The invention of the ... revolutionized long-distance travel in the 19th century.
⇒ **B) steam engine**
3. Sending messages using electric signals through wires is called:
⇒ **A) telegraph**
4. Which of these is the fastest mode of communication today?
⇒ **C) internet**
5. The Constitution of India came into effect on:
⇒ **B) 26 January 1950**
6. The Constitution of India is the ... written constitution in the world.
⇒ **B) longest**
7. The chief architect of the Indian Constitution was:
⇒ **B) Dr. B. R. Ambedkar**
8. The Constitution lays down the:
⇒ **A) fundamental rights and duties of the country**
9. India is a ... country, where people elect their representatives.
⇒ **B) democracy**
10. The three organs of the Government of India are the Legislature, Executive and:
⇒ **A) Judiciary**
11. The head of the Indian government is the:
⇒ **B) Prime Minister (Note: The President is the head of the country)**
12. The Parliament of India consists of the Lok Sabha and the:
⇒ **B) Rajya Sabha**
13. The minimum age required to vote in India is ... years.
⇒ **B) 18**
14. The body that conducts free and fair elections in India is called the:
⇒ **B) Election Commission of India**
15. The mark put on a voter's finger after voting is made using indelible:
⇒ **A) ink**
16. The system in which every adult citizen has the right to vote is called:
⇒ **A) universal adult franchise**
17. A solar eclipse occurs when the ... comes between the sun and the earth.
⇒ **A) moon**
18. A lunar eclipse occurs when the ... comes between the sun and the moon.
⇒ **B) earth**
19. A solar eclipse can occur only on a:
⇒ **B) new moon day**

20. A lunar eclipse can occur only on a:

⇒ **B) full moon day**